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Summarize the 1906 San Francisco Earthquake. What factors shaped the current landscape?

The **1906 San Francisco Earthquake** was one of the most devastating seismic events in U.S. history. It struck on **April 18, 1906**, around 5:12 a.m., along the **San Andreas Fault**, with an estimated magnitude of **7.8**. The earthquake itself caused massive structural damage, but the subsequent **fires**, fueled by ruptured gas lines and damaged water systems, destroyed large portions of the city. Overall, more than **3,000 people died**, and over **80% of San Francisco** was damaged or destroyed.

Factors that shaped the current landscape

1. **Seismic and Geologic Influence**
   - The earthquake revealed the **vulnerability of the city's built environment**, particularly on areas of **filled land**, like the Marina District and South of Market, which amplified shaking.
   - Awareness of the **San Andreas Fault system** influenced modern urban planning and building codes.
2. **Urban Reconstruction**
   - The city underwent a massive **rebuilding effort**, which included wider streets, modernized utilities, and stricter construction standards.
   - Architectural styles changed, with many Victorian buildings replaced by **fire-resistant structures**.
3. **Population and Economic Shifts**
   - Many residents temporarily or permanently relocated, reshaping neighborhoods and demographics.
   - The disaster prompted investment in **infrastructure modernization**, including water and transportation systems, which defined the city's urban landscape.
4. **Environmental Changes**
   - Fires and debris reshaped **topography and land use**, especially along waterfronts, influencing present-day zoning and urban layout.

In short, the 1906 earthquake was not just a natural disaster but a transformative event that **redefined San Francisco's urban structure, building practices, and hazard awareness**, directly shaping the city we see today.

If you want, I can make a **visual map showing pre- and post-1906 San Francisco** to highlight how the earthquake reshaped the city. Do you want me to do that?

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